

Quick Reference: Week 1 → Week 1 Deployment

Your mission: Paper trade NFL props + CFB spreads through August; validate; go live Week 1.

Files You Have

File	Purpose	Where to Use
PRE_WEEK1_PLAYBOOK.md	Strategic roadmap (read this first)	edge-index/docs/
IMMEDIATE_ACTION_ITEMS.md	Next 3 hours & 3 weeks (tactical)	Your calendar + README
cfb_power_ranking_model.py	CFB team rating calculator	edge-index/models/
weekly_performance_tracker.py	ROI + win% aggregator	edge-index/scripts/
NFL_PROPS_TRACKING_TEMPLATE.csv	Daily log template	Google Sheet or edge-index/data/
NFL_PROP_AUDIT_ANSWERS.md	Reference for 2026 learnings	edge-index/docs/audit/

This Week (Aug 25-31): Must-Do Checklist

By EOD Friday (3-4 hours total)

- ☐ **30 min:** Google Sheet for line tracking (Date | Book | Game | Player | Market | Line | Price)
- ☐ **90 min:** CFB dataset: ESPN schedules 2021-2026 + recruiting ranks → CSV
- ☐ **60 min:** CFB power ranking function: test on Bama, Texas, Ohio State
- ☐ **30 min:** Paper trading tracker: Trade_ID | Sport | Bet | Price | Model_Edge | Result | Return

Daily (10 mins/day)

10 AM ET: Pull opening lines from DK, FanDuel, BetMGM
Log in tracking sheet
Run NFL model; identify Tier 1 edges ($\geq +1.5\%$)

By Sept 1 (Week 2 start)

- ☐ Paper bet 50-75 total across both sports
- ☐ CFB model tested on 2-3 actual games
- ☐ Weekly performance report ready to generate

What Drives the Decision to Go Live

Green Light (→ live Week 1):

August ROI: +0.5% to +3%

Win rate: $\geq 52\%$

CFB model within $\pm 2\%$ calibration

48-96h placement window shows edge capture

Yellow Light (→ live with 50% bankroll):

August ROI: -2% to +0.5%

Win rate: 50-52%

Run half live, half paper through Sept

Red Light (→ extend paper through Sept):

August ROI: $< -5\%$

Any market loses $> 15\%$

Model drift detected

Daily Metrics to Watch



Running total (as of [DATE]):

OVERALL:

Total bets: ___

Win%: ___% (target: ≥52%)

Profit/Loss: ___u

ROI: __% (target: +0.5% to +3%)

BY SPORT:

NFL props: ___ bets, __% ROI

CFB spreads: ___ bets, __% ROI

BY MARKET (NFL):

rec_yds: __% ROI (expect +6-9%)

receptions: __% ROI (expect +6-9%)

pass_att: __% ROI (expect -2% to +2%)

pass_yds: AVOID (expect -8% to -10%)

BY TIMING (hours before kickoff):

0-12h: __% ROI (expect -5% to -2%)

12-48h: __% ROI (expect -1% to +1%)

48-96h: __% ROI (expect +1% to +2%)

96h+: __% ROI (expect 0% to +1%)

BY BOOK:

DraftKings: ___ ROI

FanDuel: ___ ROI

BetMGM: ___ ROI

2026 Audit Reminders (Don't Forget)

Finding	Action
+2.4% CLV but -1.34% ROI	Gap of -3.74pp = closing line fading. Expected.
rec_yds +8.62%, receptions +9.27%	Allocate 30% + 25% of bets here. These work.
pass_yds -9.68%, rush_att -8.43%	Avoid or test minimally. These don't work.
48-96h = +2.1% ROI, <12h = -6.0%	Placement timing matters. Test this hypothesis.

Finding	Action
1.12pp win-rate miss	Model overestimates by ~1pp. Recalibrate.
-20.7pp closing line fading	Lines move against you 74% of time. Normal.

NFL Props Strategy (2027)

Tier allocation:

Tier 1 (edge $\geq$ +2%): 3 units per bet (allocate 30% of bets here)

Tier 2 (edge +1.5% to +2%): 2 units per bet (allocate 25% of bets here)

Tier 3 (edge +1% to +1.5%): 1 unit per bet (allocate 15% of bets here)

Market allocation:

rec_yds: 30% $\leftarrow$ highest confidence

receptions: 25% $\leftarrow$ highest confidence

pass_att: 20%

longest_rec: 15%

other: 10%

Avoid completely:

pass_yds (consistent losses)

rush_att (consistent losses)

Placement window:

Prefer 48-96 hours before kickoff

Avoid <12 hours (excessive fading)

CFB Spreads Strategy (2027)

Power ranking weights:

Historical win rate (50%) — last 3 years

Recruiting ranks (30%) — avg rank over 3-year cohort

Returning production (15%) — QB continuity + top WR count

Coaching tenure (5%) — diminishing returns after year 3

Edge detection:

Model gives win probability $\rightarrow$ compare to market spread

Market line: if -2.5 = home favored, that's ~56.3% implied

If model says home is 51%, edge = -5.3pp → fade home

Min edge to bet: +1.5% (after validation)

Calibration check:

After 2-3 games, compare model win% vs actual results

If model too high/low by >5%, adjust weights

Placement Timing Hypothesis (to validate in August)

Hypothesis from 2026 data:

48-96h before kickoff: minimal fading, capture +2% CLV

<12h before kickoff: heavy fading, lose -5% to -6%

How to test:

Log hours_before_kickoff for every bet

Bucket into: 0-12h, 12-24h, 24-48h, 48-72h, 72-96h, 96h+

Calculate ROI by bucket

If 48-96h >> other windows, restrict placement to that window

Expected outcome:

If true, you can explain why closing line fading happens (late-entry vs early-entry)

And optimize entry timing to capture more edge

Go-Live Checklist (Sept 8 Decision)

- ☐ 100-120 paper bets logged with results
- ☐ August ROI calculated (+/- per sport, per market, per book)
- ☐ Win% by timing window computed
- ☐ CFB model backtested on 3+ games
- ☐ No single market showing > 15% loss
- ☐ Model calibration drift check (win% vs expected)
- ☐ Bankroll sized: 2,500-3,000 units for paper; how much for live?

If all  → Green Light → Go live Week 1

If mostly  but some concerns → Yellow Light → 50% live, 50% paper

If  on 2+ → Red Light → Extend paper through September

Live Deployment (Week 1+)

Once you hit Go/Yellow Light, flip these switches:

Same infrastructure, real \$ instead of paper units

Same tier system (1u, 2u, 3u per bet)

Same tracking sheet (add live \$ column)

Same daily reporting (ROI by market, by book, by timing)

Week 1 live targets:

Aim for +0% to +2% ROI (breakeven $\pm$ 2pp variance)

If <-5%, pause and audit

If >+5%, don't get overconfident (likely variance in your favor)

If Things Go Wrong

Scenario: First week ROI is -8% → Pause all live bets

→ Run audit on paper trades: did this match August results?

→ If paper also underperformed: model issue (recalibrate)

→ If paper was +1% but live is -8%: execution issue (books, timing, prices worse than expected)

Scenario: One market (e.g., rec_yds) goes -10% → Stop betting that market immediately

→ Continue others

→ Investigate: is the 2026 +8.62% result not replicable in 2027?

Scenario: 48-96h hypothesis false (window doesn't help) → Accept that closing line fading is random, not preventable

→ Adjust CLV expectations downward (maybe true edge is 0.5%, not +2%)

→ Extend paper trading for calibration

Slack/Calendar Reminders

Set these now:

Daily 10 AM (Aug 25-Sept 15): "Pull opening lines, log in tracker"

Weekly Monday (Aug 25, Sept 1, Sept 8): "Run model, identify edges"

Weekly Friday (Aug 29, Sept 5, Sept 12): "Compile weekly ROI, analyze by market/book/timing"

Sept 8: "August audit + Go/No-Go decision"

Key Files to Update in edge-index

By Sept 8, your repo should include:

```

├── edge-index/
│   ├── data/
│   │   ├── nfl/
│   │   │   ├── opening_lines_2027.csv (daily tracking)
│   │   │   ├── paper_trades_aug2027.csv (with results)
│   │   │   └── market_calibration.json (rec_yds: +8.6%, etc.)
│   │   └── cfb/
│   │       ├── team_historical.csv (2021-2026)
│   │       ├── recruiting_ranks.csv (247Sports)
│   │       ├── power_rankings_2027.csv (your model output)
│   │       └── paper_trades_aug2027.csv (with results)
│   └── models/
│       ├── nfl_props_2027.py (recalibrated from 2026)
│       └── cfb_spreads_2027.py (power ranking function)
├── scripts/
│   └── weekly_performance_tracker.py
└── docs/
    ├── PRE_WEEK1_PLAYBOOK.md
    ├── IMMEDIATE_ACTION_ITEMS.md
    └── 2026_AUDIT.md (reference)
```

Recommended Tools

For line tracking:

Google Sheet (easiest, shareable, mobile-friendly)

Or CSV + Python script (if you prefer local)

For CFB data:

ESPN: <https://www.espn.com/college-football/schedule>

247Sports recruiting: <https://247sports.com/Rankings/Football/Recruiting/>

Pandas + requests for scraping

For paper trading:

Google Sheet (same as line tracker)

Or local CSV + Python for analysis

For reporting:

Python script: `weekly_performance_tracker.py` (generates weekly summaries)

Or manual Google Sheets formulas (if you prefer)

Success = Live Money

You've got all the pieces. The next 3 weeks are about validation.

By Sept 8: You'll have 100-120 bets logged, know your true edge (not just CLV), and make the call to deploy real capital.

By Sept 15: You'll be live on Week 1 NFL props + CFB Week 1 spreads, running the same infrastructure you built in August.

By Oct 1: You'll have 300-400 live bets, real \$ on the line, and data to refine for next season.

Let's go.